Janoden Masbud Gubat

Janoden Masbud Gubat (born March 30, 1974) is a Maranao electrical engineer, government official, civic leader, and Sultan a Cabugatan sa Maul of the Royal Sultanate of Maul in Marantao, Lanao del Sur.

He carries a rare combination of credentials: a licensed electrical engineer who has worked on billion-peso infrastructure projects in both the Philippines and the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia, a government executive who helped shape national land reform and data privacy policy, and a hereditary sultan who continues to serve his community through organized civic work.

Over more than two decades of professional life spanning Mindanao, Metro Manila, and the Arabian Peninsula, Gubat has built a track record rooted in technical excellence, public service, and Maranao cultural leadership. He is perhaps best understood as a builder in every sense of the word: of power plants, of government systems, of civic institutions, and of the communities he belongs to.

Contents

1 Background
2 Education
3 Career
    3.1 Early Practice in Mindanao
    3.2 Saudi Arabia: Military and Infrastructure Engineering
    3.3 Return to the Philippines: Private Sector
    3.4 Government Service: Department of Agrarian Reform
4 Organizational Affiliations and Civic Leadership
5 Legacy
6 Recognition
7 Challenges
8 See Also
9 References

Background

Janoden Masbud Gubat is Maranao, a member of one of the indigenous Muslim peoples of Lanao del Sur in the Bangsamoro region of Mindanao.

His connection to the Royal Sultanate of Maul in Marantao is not just historical or ceremonial. As Sultan a Cabugatan sa Maul, he holds a living position within the traditional Maranao royal system, a responsibility that runs alongside his professional and civic roles rather than separate from them.

He currently resides in Bacoor City, Cavite, in the Camella Homes community, which reflects the broader reality of many Maranao professionals who have settled in Luzon while maintaining deep ties to their Bangsamoro roots.

He is also Executive Vice President of the Royal Sultanate of Lanao, further anchoring his role within the broader network of Maranao traditional governance.

Education

Gubat pursued his foundational engineering degree at Cagayan de Oro College, earning a Bachelor of Science in Electrical Engineering.

He later studied law at Mindanao State University, one of the premier institutions serving the Muslim Filipino community, though his career trajectory ultimately leaned toward engineering and public administration.

He earned a Master in Management, Major in Public Administration, from Philippine Christian University, deepening his grounding in governance and organizational leadership.

He holds a Doctor of Humanities from Piedmont College of Theology, recognizing his contributions to service and community leadership.

He was also conferred a Doctor in Philosophy in Executive Leadership, Major in Leadership Management and Public Service, by Brethren Evangelical School of Theology International, awarded Honoris Causa.

His professional licenses reflect the depth of his technical qualifications: he is a Registered Electrical Engineer, a Registered Master Electrician under the Philippine Regulatory Commission, and a Registered Engineer with the Saudi Council of Engineers, which enabled him to practice his profession at the highest levels in the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia.

Career

Early Practice in Mindanao

Gubat began his professional engineering career with BRIMA Construction in Iligan City, where he served as Project Electrical Engineer from April 2000 to February 2008.

During this period, he worked on government facilities across the Mindanao region, gaining foundational experience in project supervision, electrical systems installation, and coordination across engineering disciplines.

This Mindanao chapter gave Gubat his professional footing: planning electrical works, evaluating materials, preparing progress reports, and working within multi-disciplinary construction teams. It was the kind of on-the-ground experience that would serve him well in far larger theatres.

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Born	March 30, 1974
Nationality	Filipino
Ethnicity	Maranao
Civil Status	Married
Royal Title	Sultan a Cabugatan sa Maul, Royal Sultanate of Maul, Marantao
Also Known As	Sultan Janoden Masbud Gubat
Professional Licenses	Registered Electrical Engineer (Philippines); Registered Master Electrician (Philippines); Registered Engineer, Saudi Council of Engineers
Education	BS Electrical Engineering, Cagayan de Oro College; College of Law, Mindanao State University; Master in Management (Public Administration), Philippine Christian University; Doctor of Humanities, Piedmont College of Theology; Doctor in Philosophy in Executive Leadership (Honoris Causa),

Saudi Arabia: Military and Infrastructure Engineering

	Brethren Evangelical School of Theology International
Occupation	Electrical Engineer; Government Executive; Civic Leader; Sultan
Residence	Bacoor City, Cavite

In 2008, Gubat moved to the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia, where he would spend the next eight years working on some of the most consequential military and infrastructure projects in the region.

He joined Al-Arab Contracting Company in Al-Taif from May 2008 to May 2010 as Project Electrical Engineer, assigned to two major projects.

The first was the Typhoon Project, covering Royal Saudi Air Force aircraft facilities at King Fahad Airbase in Al-Hawiya, Al-Taif, with a project cost of 1 billion Saudi Riyals. This involved Typhoon jet fighter facilities, bomb shelters, and comprehensive military infrastructure.

The second was the Taif Handicap Hospital, a 300-bed facility within Taif Military Camp, under the General Directorate of Military Works, valued at 100 million SAR.

In 2010, Gubat moved into a consultancy role as Senior Regional Electrical Engineer Consultant with the Ministry of Defense (MOD) and General Directorate of Military Works (GDMW), based at King Khalid Military City in Hafar Al-Batin, Northern Region, Kingdom of Saudi Arabia.

He held this role from September 2010 to September 2016, sponsored successively by Abdullah Al-Saif and Partners for Engineering Consulting (2010 to 2013) and Al-Rajhi Engineering Consulting (2013 to 2016).

During this six-year tenure, he oversaw a remarkable portfolio of projects, including the following:

The 25 MW, 13.8 KV Gas Turbine and Generator Power Plant (Project No. 2/7/186), valued at 90 million SAR, was completed between November 2010 and May 2013.

The 800 Military Housing Units (Project No. 1/7/9), valued at 650 million SAR, ran from September 2010 to July 2012.

The Hawk Missiles Storage Facility (Project No. 5/7/2), valued at 7 million SAR, was completed between September 2010 and August 2012.

Primary Substation upgrading and Telephone Communication Facilities projects were completed between October 2011 and April 2013, at a combined cost of 17 million SAR.

The Sewer Treatment Plant (Project No. 2/7/277D), valued at 15 million SAR, was completed between March 2011 and October 2013.

Multiple school projects were completed between 2011 and 2015, including boys and girls elementary, intermediate, and high school facilities valued at a combined 81.5 million SAR.

The Missiles Launcher Patriot project for the Royal Saudi Air Defense (Project No. 13/12/4), covering three sites, was valued at 245 million SAR and ran from March 2013 to November 2015.

The Royal Saudi Air Defense General Headquarters (Project No. 3/7/4), valued at 260 million SAR, and the Royal Saudi Air Force Housing project (Project No. 3/7/5), valued at 250 million SAR, were both completed through 2015 and 2016.

His responsibilities across these projects included reviewing shop drawings, evaluating contractor claims, conducting manufacturer inspections, representing the Regional Director in executive meetings, overseeing electrical commissioning and testing, and preparing weekly and monthly progress reports.

Return to the Philippines: Private Sector

Returning to the Philippines after his Saudi contract ended, Gubat joined Solid South Engineering Services in Pasig City as Senior Electrical Engineer Consultant from November 2016 to December 2018.

He oversaw electrical designs, coordinated multi-discipline construction activities, and supported project management functions across multiple concurrent construction projects.

In September 2020, he joined Design Science, Inc. as Senior Electrical Engineer Consultant on the Metro Manila Skyway Stage 3 project (the NLEX-SLEX Link) under San Miguel Corporation, a role he held until February 2021.

His duties included evaluating contractor and subcontractor performance, reviewing technical submittals, attending executive-level meetings between San Miguel Corporation and project contractors, and serving as the representative of the Project Manager in key transactions.

Government Service: Department of Agrarian Reform

Gubat entered government service with the Department of Agrarian Reform (DAR), initially as Technical Staff-1 in the Office of the Undersecretary for Special Concerns from January to June 2019.

In this capacity, he provided legal and technical inputs for the nationwide Validation of Certificate of Land Ownership Awardees (CLOAs) and Emancipation Patents (EPs), participated in Technical Working Group discussions on the Rice Tariffication and Liberalization Law (RA 11203), and represented the Undersecretary in public occasions and agrarian reform beneficiary engagements.

He returned to DAR from July 2021 to June 2022 as Executive Assistant III and concurrent Chief of Staff of the Undersecretary for Special Concerns Office.

In this senior role, he led the planning of all activities of the Undersecretary's office, represented the DAR in inter-agency meetings, reviewed project proposals, special orders, and policy memoranda, and directed the office's staff functions.

Critically, he was appointed Team Leader of the DAR-Data Privacy Act Task Force under Special Order No. 343, Series of 2021, mandated to bring the Department into full compliance with the Data Privacy Act of 2012 (RA 10173).

This task force work included leading Privacy Impact Assessment clustering exercises across Mindanao, Visayas, Luzon, and the DAR Central Office, crafting the Department's control framework for personal data processing, and representing DAR in data-sharing agreement negotiations with other government agencies.

He also served as Team Leader for the Validation of Certificate of Land Ownership Awarded/Emancipation Patent (CLOA/CCLOA/EP), covering both privately acquired and government-owned distributed agricultural lands under Special Order No. 610, Series of 2021.

Organizational Affiliations and Civic Leadership

Gubat has been deeply embedded in civic life across multiple organizations, reflecting a consistent personal commitment to community building alongside his professional and royal responsibilities.

Within the Fraternal Order of Eagles-Philippine Eagles, he served as Charter and Regional Governor of NCR 68, with his region earning the "2023 Remarkable Region" award. He was also Commissioner of the National Commission on Education for 2023 and 2024, Charter President of the Luminous Eagles Club (NCR 3, which received "Best Club" and "Best Club President" recognitions), and Club Secretary of the Premier Eagles Club (NCR 3, earning "Most Active Regional Member" recognition).

In Rotary International, he served as Charter President and "Hope Creating President" of the Rotary Club of Diliman International (District 3780), which received the Club Excellence Award. He also served as "Life Changing President" of the Rotary Club of Manila Quiapo Central (District 3810), which he led to receive "Most Outstanding Club" and "Most Outstanding Club President" designations, alongside eight major and 34 minor awards during his term.

He is a Board of Trustee and Founder of the Greenhills Muslim Business Club Foundation Inc., a Founding Chairman and President of Samahan ng Maharlikang Pilipino, and serves as National Chairman on Muslim Affairs of Community Force Multipliers for Peace Inc. (CFMPI).

He has served as Secretary General and National Executive Director for Operation of United Christian Muslim Against Crime and Corruption Inc., as Vice President for Anti-Corruption and Criminal Investigation of the Association of Chief of Police of the Philippines, and as Director for Muslim Affairs of Apila ng Bayan Inc.

He is a member of Xi Kappa Sigma, Mu Kappa Phi Exclusive Law Fraternity, the Saudi Council of Engineers, and the Institute of Integrated Electrical Engineers of the Philippines (IIEE).

Legacy

Janoden Masbud Gubat's legacy sits at the intersection of technical mastery, public service, and Maranao cultural continuity.

He belongs to a generation of Muslim Filipinos who carried their professional skills far beyond the boundaries of Bangsamoro, building military cities in the Arabian Peninsula and infrastructure corridors in Metro Manila, while never stepping away from the responsibilities of community and identity back home.

His work in the Department of Agrarian Reform connected his engineering precision to the cause of land justice for Filipino farmers, and his role in the DAR-Data Privacy Act Task Force reflects an understanding that governance in the 21st century requires technical fluency, not just administrative rank.

As Sultan a Cabugatan sa Maul and Executive Vice President of the Royal Sultanate of Lanao, he continues the Maranao tradition of leadership as a form of accountability: to one's lineage, one's community, and one's faith.

Across his civic affiliations, from Rotary to the Fraternal Order of Eagles to interfaith organizations working against crime and corruption, his consistent theme has been bridge-building: between communities, between institutions, and between generations.

Recognition

Gubat has received recognition in multiple civic arenas:

His region (NCR 68) received the "2023 Remarkable Region" award under the Fraternal Order of Eagles-Philippine Eagles during his term as Regional Governor.

The Luminous Eagles Club (NCR 3), which he founded and led as Charter President, earned "Best Club" and "Best Club President" designations.

During his presidency of the Rotary Club of Manila Quiapo Central (District 3810), the club was recognized as "Most Outstanding Club," and Gubat was named "Most Outstanding Club President," with the club earning a total of eight major and 34 minor awards in that period.

The Rotary Club of Diliman International (District 3780) received the Club Excellence Award during his tenure as Charter President.

He holds honorary doctoral degrees from Piedmont College of Theology (Doctor of Humanities) and Brethren Evangelical School of Theology International (Doctor in Philosophy in Executive Leadership, Honoris Causa), recognizing his service, leadership, and public contributions.

Challenges

Gubat's career illustrates the resilience required of Muslim Filipino professionals navigating spaces where their identity and credentials are not always recognized together.

Building a licensed engineering career that spans Philippine government service, international military infrastructure, and civic leadership simultaneously is not a straightforward path. Each domain carries its own demands, expectations, and gatekeeping, and Gubat has had to demonstrate competence and credibility across all of them.

His work on data privacy compliance at DAR reflects the additional complexity that comes with technical roles inside bureaucratic environments, where institutional resistance and legacy practices often slow the implementation of needed reforms.

His simultaneous responsibilities as sultan, engineer, civic leader, and government executive also speak to the weight carried by individuals who belong to communities that are underrepresented in national institutions, and who feel obligated to represent those communities with distinction in every room they enter.

See Also

- BangsamoroPedia
- Maranao people
- Royal Sultanate of Lanao
- Department of Agrarian Reform (Philippines)
- Institute of Integrated Electrical Engineers of the Philippines
- Rotary International in the Philippines
- Data Privacy Act of 2012 (Philippines)

References

- Curriculum Vitae and Professional Profile of Janoden Masbud Gubat (personal document).
- Department of Agrarian Reform, Special Order No. 343, Series of 2021 (DAR-Data Privacy Act Task Force).
- Department of Agrarian Reform, Special Order No. 610, Series of 2021 (Task Force Camp Keithly Military Reservation).
- Fraternal Order of Eagles-Philippine Eagles, NCR 68 Regional Records.
- Rotary International District 3780 and District 3810 Club Records.

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